SMM
Shanghai Metals Market

SMM IRON ORE DAILY

SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-10-16 Friday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply–Demand · Inventory · Commentary

Source **SMM / SGX**

Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

SGX Iron Ore Current-month Contract Latest price

91.00 USD/dmt

FEFV26 · 2026-10 · SGX

As of preparation: 2026-10-16 17:48:45 (UTC+8)
Quote time: 10-16 17:30:47 (UTC+8)

DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701 Daily

672.5 yuan/mt

▲ +1.0 +0.15%

MTD avg **677.6**

As of Oct 16 · vs Oct 15

SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Five MMi indices as of Oct 16

Index	Value	Change	MTD avg
MMi 61% Port Spot Daily	656 yuan/wmt	▲ +2 +0.31%	659
MMi 58% Port Spot Daily	614 yuan/wmt	▼ -1 -0.16%	620
MMi 65% Port Spot Daily	815 yuan/wmt	▲ +2 +0.25%	821
MMi 61% Seaborne Index Daily	89.40 USD/dmt	▲ +0.60 +0.68%	90.57
MMi 65% Seaborne Index Daily	107.75 USD/dmt	▲ +0.25 +0.23%	109.50
SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index Daily	796.81 yuan/mt	▼ -24.77 -3.01%	818.50

As of Oct 16 · vs Oct 15

Key View

Seaborne prices and futures recover modestly, but domestic spot divergence keeps buying in focus

Prices recovered to some extent, but the rebound was not uniform. DCE most-traded closed at 672.5 yuan/mt, up 0.15%. The seaborne 61% and 65% indices rose 0.68% and 0.23% to USD 89.40 and 107.75/dmt, respectively, while all 12 brand quotations increased. Most port products rose 2 yuan/wmt, but Carajas Fines fell 8 yuan and PB Lump was unchanged. The domestic ore composite index declined to 796.81 yuan/mt, highlighting differences in support across markets.

Costs offered a marginal cushion. C3 and C5 freight continued lower and SMM's average import margin recovered to 6.01 yuan/mt. However, stronger import trading margins do not mean mills have greater buying capacity. Needs-based purchases and controlled arrivals persist; sustained improvement in transactions would provide a stronger test of the recovery than a single day's price gain.

Firmer quotations should be distinguished from a change in the demand trend. Improving end-user orders and mill margins could gradually generate sustained restocking and price support. If discretionary buying remains limited, port stocks and product-specific supply may constrain the rebound. A low-level, range-bound view remains appropriate while watching purchasing persistence, hot metal and inventory absorption rather than treating a one-day rise as a trend reversal.

Today's Highlights

- **Futures edged higher while port spot brands diverged.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at **672.5 yuan/mt**, up 1.0 yuan (+0.15%). Qingdao PB Fines were 642, Newman Fines 645 and Mac Fines 646 yuan/wmt, each up 2 yuan; Carajas Fines fell 8 yuan to 817 and PB Lump held at 826.
- **Both seaborne indices and all 12 brands recovered.** The 61% index was **USD 89.40/dmt**, up 0.60 (+0.68%), and the 65% was **107.75**, up 0.25 (+0.23%). All 12 brands rose against Oct 15, with PB Fines at 89.75, Newman Fines 88.85 and Mac Fines 89.15 USD/dmt.
- **Composite port indices showed mixed performance.** The 61%, 58% and 65% indices were 656, 614 and 815 yuan/wmt, changing by +2, −1 and +2 yuan. The 65%–58% spread widened from 198 to 201 yuan/wmt; individual brands and composite indices need not move together.
- **The domestic ore composite index declined.** SMM's Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was **796.81 yuan/mt**, down 24.77 yuan (−3.01%) from 821.58. Domestic and seaborne markets diverged this period, leaving the persistence of buying and transactions central to assessing price support.

Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

Product	10-16 (yuan/wmt)	Daily change / %	MTD avg	Last 12 months
PB Fines 60.8% Daily	642	▲ +2 +0.31%	646	
Newman Fines 61.2% Daily	645	▲ +2 +0.31%	649	*
Mac Fines 60.8% Daily	647	▲ +3 +0.47%	649	
BRBF 62.5% Daily	692	▲ +2 +0.29%	697	
Newman Lump 63% Daily	837	▲ +2 +0.24%	841	
Super Special Fines (SSF) 56.5% Daily	504	▲ +2 +0.40%	508	
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	812	▼ -13 -1.58%	827	
PB Lump 61.5% Daily	826	— 0 0.00%	835	*

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

Product	10-16 (USD/dmt)	Daily change / %	10-15
Roy Hill Fines 62% Daily	86.20	▲ +0.65 +0.76%	85.55
SIMEC Fines 61% Daily	87.90	▲ +0.65 +0.74%	87.25
PB Fines 62% Daily	89.75	▲ +0.60 +0.67%	89.15
Newman Fines 60.7% Daily	88.85	▲ +0.65 +0.74%	88.20
Mac Fines 60.5% Daily	89.15	▲ +0.60 +0.68%	88.55
Jimblebar Fines 60.30% Daily	85.80	▲ +0.60 +0.70%	85.20
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	105.60	▲ +0.90 +0.86%	104.70
SSFT / SSFG 60% Daily	95.95	▲ +1.00 +1.05%	94.95
Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF) 64% Daily	95.75	▲ +0.85 +0.90%	94.90
RTX Fines 61% Daily	84.80	▲ +0.60 +0.71%	84.20
West Pilbara Fines (WPF) 60% Daily	89.30	▲ +0.65 +0.73%	88.65
SP10 Fines 59%-60% Daily	78.45	▲ +0.60 +0.77%	77.85

SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

Index	Month-to-date avg	MoM	YTD	Unit	Last 12 months
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	90.57	-6.16%	-15.6%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	109.50	-4.30%	-11.2%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	659	-4.82%	-19.3%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	821	-2.18%	-9.3%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	620	-4.21%	-14.5%	yuan/wmt	
SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index Daily	818.50	-2.39%	-10.1%	yuan/mt	

The seaborne 61% index was USD 89.40/dmt (+0.68%) and the 65% was 107.75 (+0.23%), narrowing their spread from USD 18.70 to 18.35/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 656, 614 and 815 yuan/wmt, changing by +2, −1 and +2 yuan.

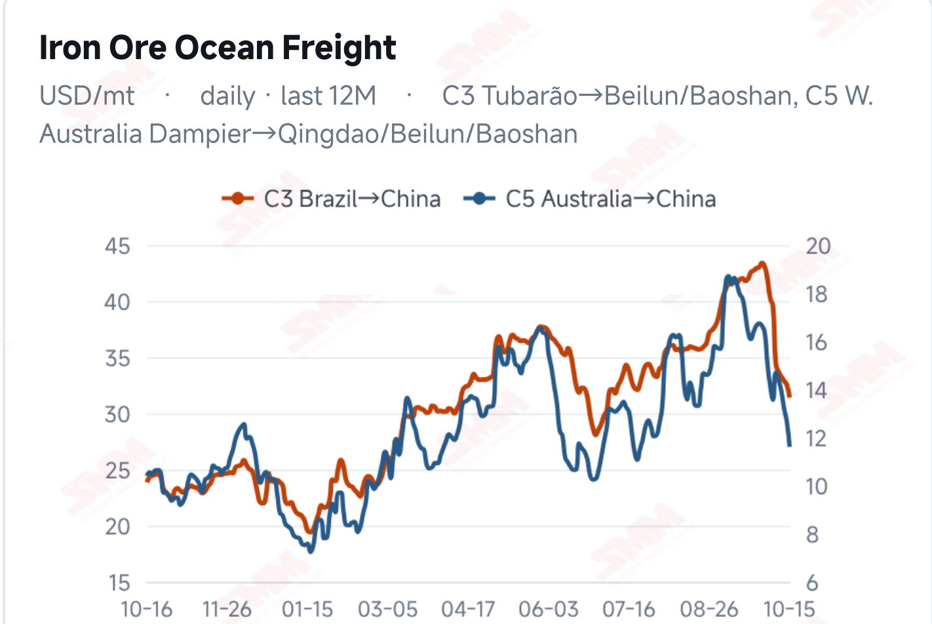
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months

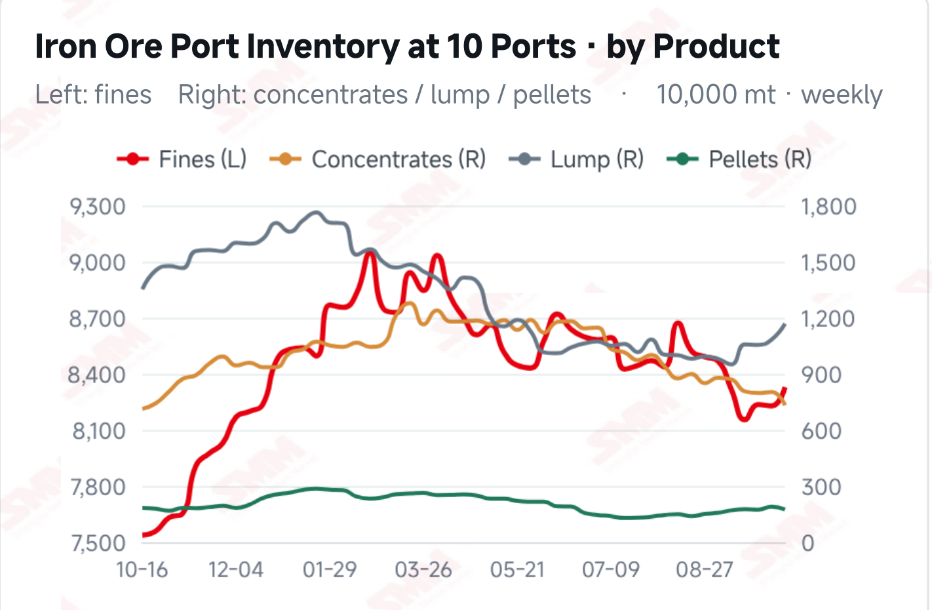
Iron Ore Ocean Freight

USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarão→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan



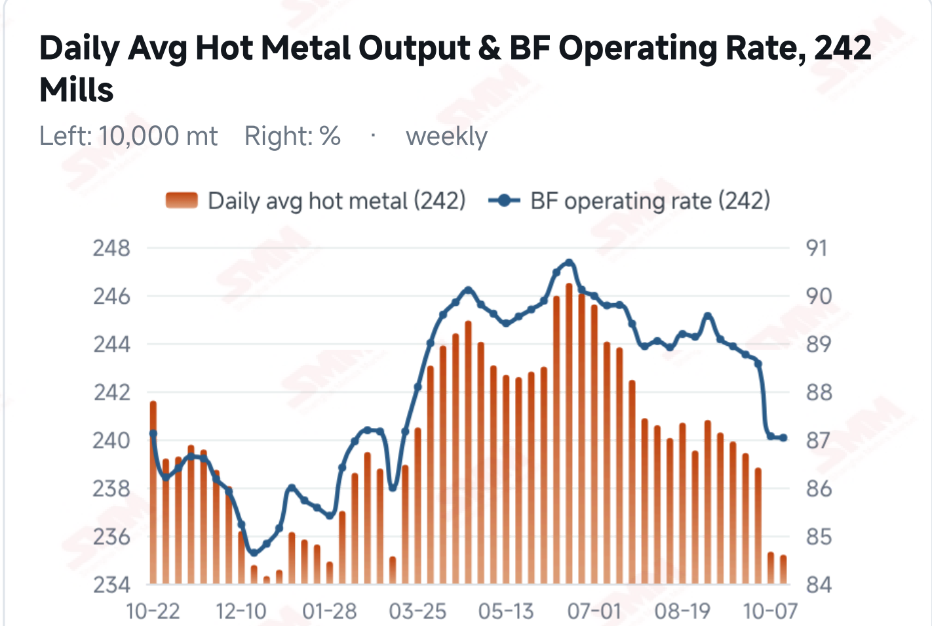
Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product

Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly



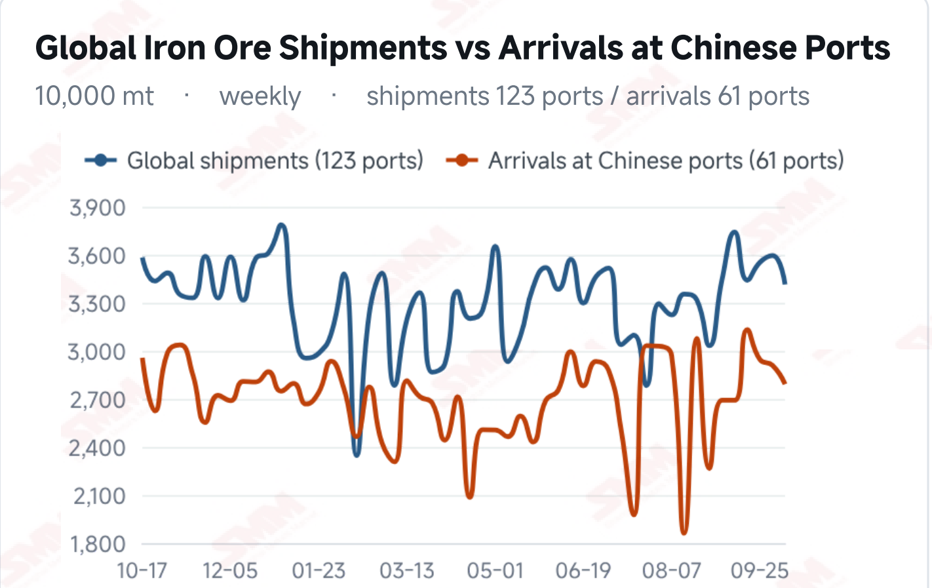
Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills

Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly



Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports

10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports



Market Commentary · Imported Ore

Futures & spot	DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 672.5 yuan/mt, up 0.15% from Oct 15. Qingdao PB Fines were 642, Newman Fines 645, Mac Fines 646, BRBF 692, Newman Lump 837 and SSF 504 yuan/wmt, each up 2 yuan; Carajas Fines fell 8 yuan to 817 while PB Lump held at 826. SGX official current-month FEFV26 was last priced at USD 91.00/dmt, timestamped Oct 16, 17:30:47 (UTC+8). SMM's daily review reported reasonable trader willingness to offer, needs-based mill restocking and thin overall trading.
Drivers	Seaborne composite indices and brand quotations recovered and domestic futures edged higher, but port products did not all rise together, showing structural differences in the recovery. The rebound may reflect adjustments in offers and buying schedules; its durability requires confirmation from actual transactions. The seaborne 61% index rose more than the 65%, narrowing their spread from USD 18.70 to 18.35/dmt. A one-day spread change alone is insufficient to establish a shift in blending demand.
Demand	SMM's Oct 16 coke briefing described cautious, needs-based mill purchases and controlled arrivals. Cost relief has not translated broadly into discretionary restocking. The latest 242-mill survey showed daily hot metal output of 2.3520 million mt on Oct 14, down 1,200 mt from Oct 7. A narrower decline may ease concerns about further demand contraction, but a recovery still depends on orders, margins and maintenance implementation.
Inventory & supply	Ten-port stocks were 104.0212 million mt on Oct 15, up 1.0047 million mt from Sep 30, with increases in fines and lump and declines in concentrates and pellets. This comparison spans the holiday, and product trends may reflect both arrivals and mill collection patterns. Global shipments of 34.1393 million mt and Chinese arrivals of 27.9147 million mt in the week to Oct 9 both declined from the preceding survey week. Whether lower flows ease inventory pressure still depends on subsequent trading and collections.
Cost & margin	SMM's Oct 16 imported ore cost-and-margin assessment put the period's average import margin at 6.01 yuan/mt, up 4.91 yuan from 1.10. This measures import trading rather than steelmaking profitability. Oct 15 freight was USD 31.39/mt for C3 (−3.50%) and 11.60 for C5 (−8.23%), offering potential cost relief. Expectations for the next coke price move remain contested; changes not yet implemented should not be treated as realised cost improvements.

Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

Prices	The Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was 796.81 yuan/mt on Oct 16, down 24.77 yuan (−3.01%) from 821.58. Regional quotations and the national composite index measure different markets and should not be substituted for one another.
Supply & demand	SMM's Oct 16 west Liaoning brief described quiet trading, cautious trader restocking and pressure on bids. Producers were reluctant to offer large concessions because of elevated earlier costs, tight ore feedstock and difficulty replenishing at low prices, preferring to wait. Mill losses and cost-control pressure continued to sustain strong buyer resistance.
Outlook	SMM expects west Liaoning concentrate prices to remain soft and range-bound in the short term. Supply constraints coexist with pressure on bids, leaving stabilisation dependent on actual transactions. Improved mill profitability followed by stronger buying could provide better support for some resources.

Market Factors

▲ Supportive factors

- Both seaborne indices and all 12 brand quotations recovered.
- DCE edged higher and most port products rose 2 yuan.
- Average import margins recovered to 6.01 yuan/mt.
- Lower C3 and C5 freight may reduce landed costs for some cargoes.

▼ Bearish factors

- Port Carajas Fines fell 8 yuan, making the spot recovery uneven.
- The domestic ore composite index fell 3.01%.
- Needs-based purchases and controlled arrivals still constrain discretionary restocking.
- Ten-port stocks remained higher than before the holiday, leaving prices reliant on trading support.

Flash News

- [Domestic Iron Ore Brief] Iron ore concentrates prices in west Liaoning may consolidate on a subdued note ↗
  2026-10-16
- Port stocks build 2.85 million mt as dispatch slips, keeping iron ore soft [SMM Daily Iron Ore Brief] ↗
  2026-10-16
- [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Brief] 20261016 ↗
  2026-10-16
- [SMM Steel] Firmer Rupee Puts Indian HRC Export Returns Under Pressure ↗
  2026-10-16
- [SMM Steel] European HRC: CBAM Compliance Risks Disrupt Import Trade as Mills Push Q1 Forward Prices ↗
  2026-10-16
- [SMM Steel] Vietnam HRC Import Prices Stable as Indonesian Supply Remains Competitive ↗
  2026-10-16

2026 SMM ASEAN
FERROUS METALS SUMMIT
November 26-27 EQ Hotel Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia
400+ Delegates
20+ Exhibitors
50+ Speakers
30+ Countries & Regions
10+ Dedicated Topics
Scan to Register
SMM

Contact Us - (Email :prices@mmiprices.com)

Shu Qing
Domestic Information Sales
+86 187 8199 7577

Wang Jiahui
Domestic Information Sales
+86 155 2492 4450

Leah Zhang
Overseas Information Sales
+86 136 6193 3462

Jack Teah
Overseas Analyst
+60 11 6680 1225

Disclaimer: This report is compiled by SMM from the SMM Data-pro database and SMM's own news coverage. All prices, inventories, output, shipment and arrival figures follow SMM's survey and statistical methodology and are provided for reference only; they do not constitute investment advice. Markets carry risk — please make decisions prudently. Reproduction, excerpting or other use of this report without permission is prohibited.
© 2026 Shanghai Metals Market (SMM)